

- Overview
- Growth & Scale
- Insight & Recommendation

Years of History

18

1978- 2025

Peak Visitors

3M

2011 Edition

Total of Publishers

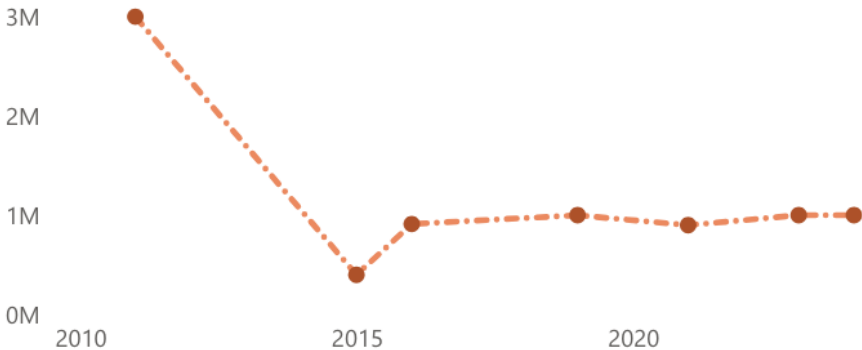
2K

2024 Edition

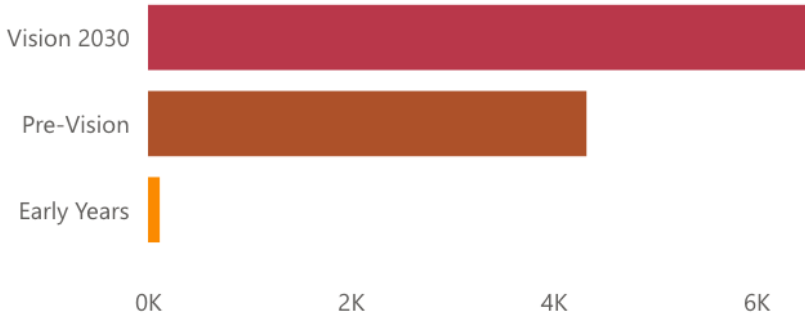
Sales 2024

25M

Visitors Growth over the Years



Number of Publishers by Era



Organiser

All

Year

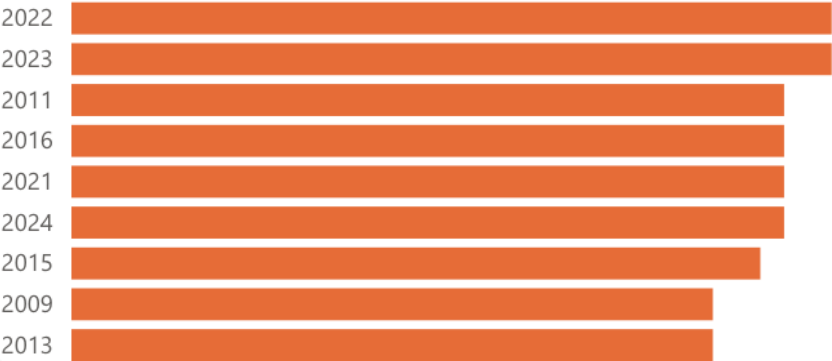
All

Year	Milestone	Organiser	Guest of Honour
1978	First edition · 120 publishers	King Saud University	
2011	Record 3M visitors	Ministry of Information	India
2018	Ministry of Culture takes over	Ministry of Culture	UAE
2019	First 1M visitors milestone	Ministry of Culture	Bahrain
2020	Cancelled — COVID-19	—	
2022	2 Guinness World Records	Literature, Publishing & Translation Commission	Tunisia
2024	2,000 publishers · 25M SAR	Literature, Publishing & Translation Commission	Qatar

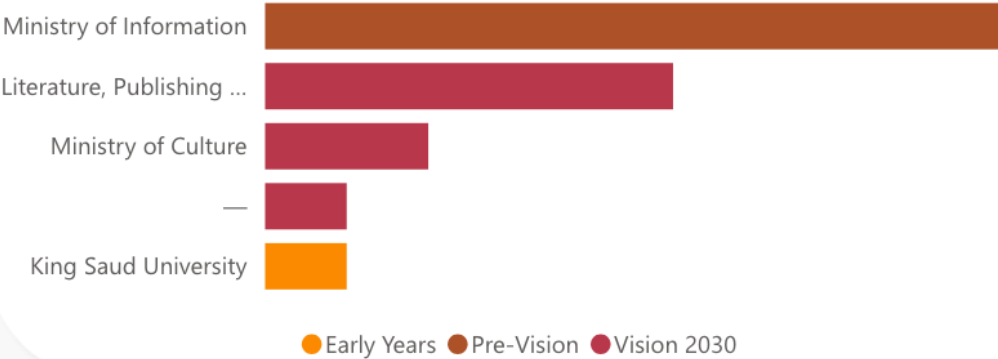
Growth & Scale

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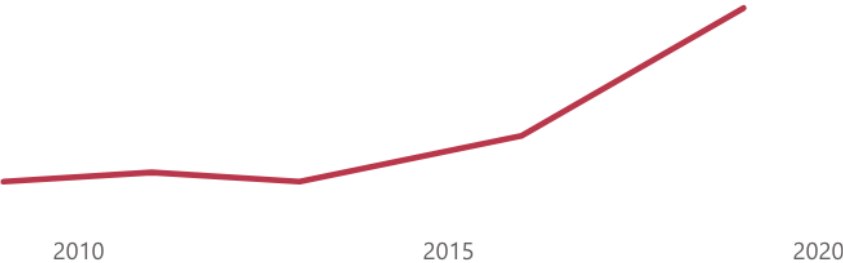
Countries Participating over time



Organiser Timeline

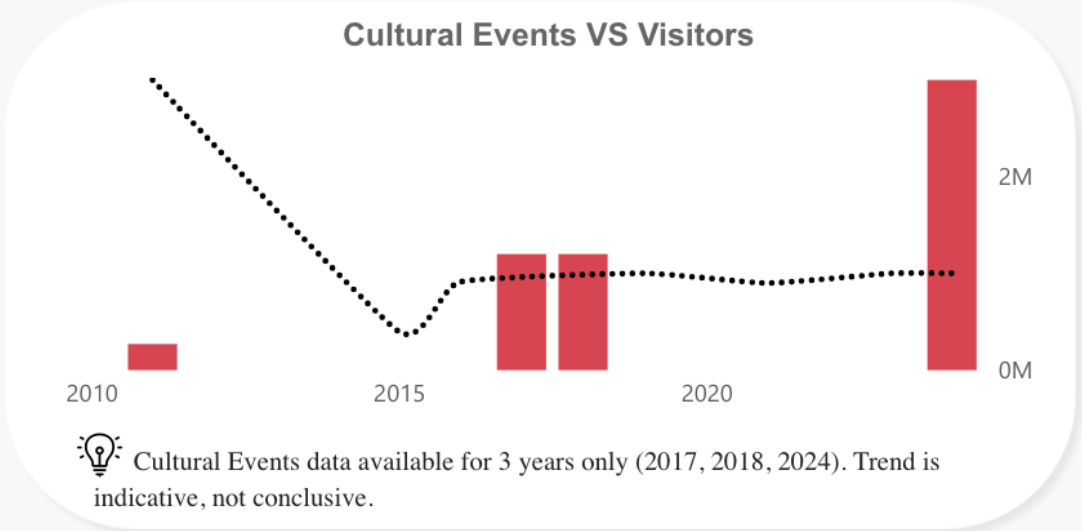
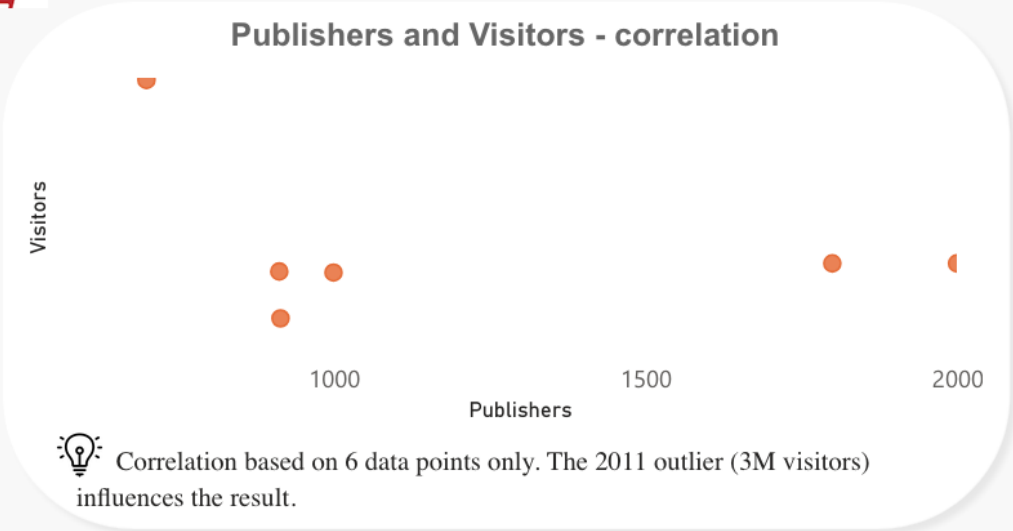


Growth of Titles by Year



Year	Guest of Honour	Theme	
2011	India	—	3M visitors — record
2017	Malaysia	—	260K print + 900K dig
2013	Morocco	Dialogue: Culture and Behaviour	
2023	Oman	An Inspiring Destination	Source: Publishing Tre
2024	Qatar	Riyadh Reads	Sales exceeded 25M S
2010	Senegal	—	
2015	South Africa	The Book: Coexistence	Source: Ministry of Inf
2012	Sweden	Reading is Life	First year with official :
2022	Tunisia	Chapters of Culture	2 Guinness World Rec
2018	UAE	The Book is the Future of Transformation	First year under Minist

Insight & Recommendations



Insight

Recommendations

①

Publish annual impact data openly

The fair currently lacks consistent public reporting. An annual data report covering visitors, publishers, sales, and cultural events would position LPT as a data-driven institution and enable year-on-year benchmarking against global book fairs.

②

Target regional expansion beyond Riyadh

All growth has been concentrated in Riyadh. With the Jeddah Book Fair growing in parallel, there is a clear opportunity to develop a national book fair calendar that serves readers across all 13 regions , directly supporting the Libraries Commission's

③

Leverage the Guest of Honour programme strategically

Since 2008, guest of honour countries have spanned Asia, Africa, Europe, and the Arab world. A strategic selection framework aligned with Saudi cultural diplomacy goals ,particularly countries targeted under Vision 2030 partnerships ,would amplify the fair's soft power impact beyond its borders.